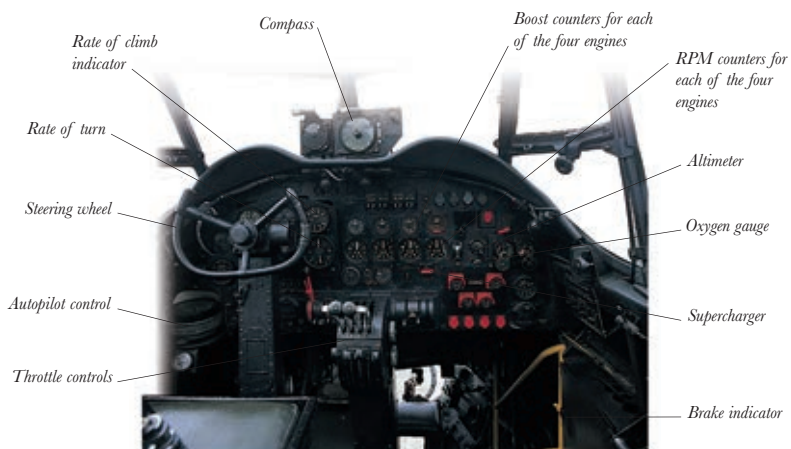




EQUIPMENT CHECK

The pilot and flight engineer (who doubled as a copilot) check the Lancaster's controls and discuss their route before a nighttime sortie.



COCKPIT INTERIOR

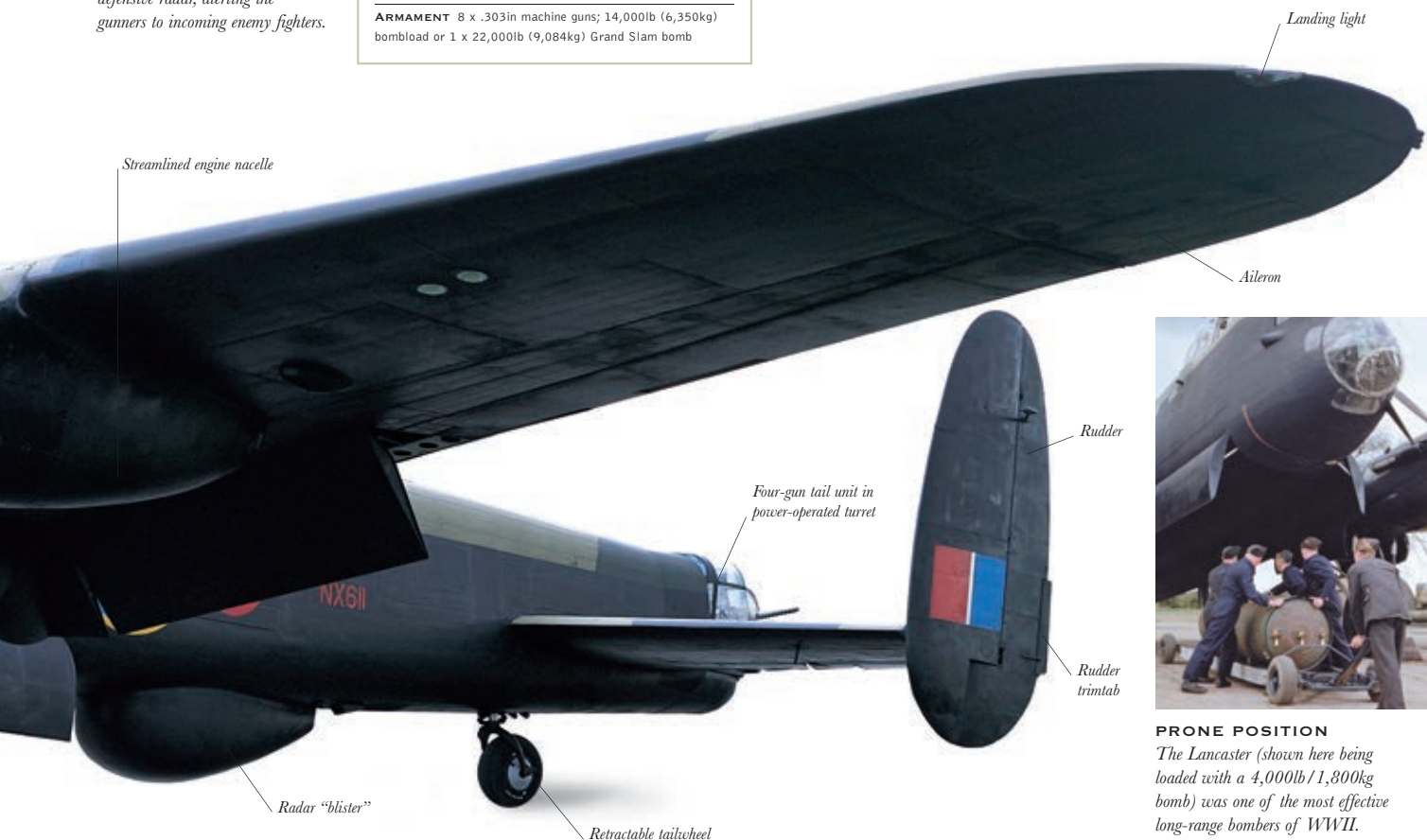
The Lancaster was fully equipped for night flying, with an impressive range of flight instruments, including two sets of four dials for its high-powered Merlin engines. The flight engineer doubled as copilot although he was rarely well trained enough to land the bomber safely. If the pilot was killed, the crew usually bailed out.

Specifications (Mk. X)

ENGINE	4 x 1,390hp Packard Merlin 28-piston
WINGSPAN	102ft (31m)
LENGTH	68ft 11in (21m)
HEIGHT	19ft 6in (5.9m)
WEIGHT	68,000lb (30,855kg)
TOP SPEED	270mph (434kph)
CREW	7
ARMAMENT	8 x .303in machine guns; 14,000lb (6,350kg) bombload or 1 x 22,000lb (9,084kg) Grand Slam bomb

TUNING IN

A radio operator finds his wavelength and checks his equipment prior to takeoff. Communications were conducted in Morse code — note the Morse key beside his right hand. The operator also handled the aircraft's defensive radar, alerting the gunners to incoming enemy fighters.



PRONE POSITION

The Lancaster (shown here being loaded with a 4,000lb/1,800kg bomb) was one of the most effective long-range bombers of WWII.